Postscript

The first indications that fresh winds of change were going to blow away the existing structures of governance in the state of Jammu and Kashmir were noticed on Monday, 22 July 2019, when the Pakistani Prime Minister Imran Khan, the Pakistan Army Chief Gen. Jawed Bajwa and the ISI Chief Lt Gen. Faiz Hameed met the US President Trump at the Oval Office in the White House. The Pakistani ruling troika desperately needed to regain their clout with the US in order to balance their current vassal like the relationship with China.

With the US Congressional elections due in November 2019 and the start of campaigning in January 2020 for the US Presidential elections, Trump is desperate for the plan of an honourable American exit from Afghanistan to be in place by 1 September 2019, after an 18-year deployment in that country. Pakistan has promised to deliver this as it controls the Taliban opposition in Afghanistan. In return, Pakistan desires a resumption of military aid from the US to help push India to the talks' table on Kashmir, and to have a decisive say in the future of Afghanistan with the elimination of India's role in that war-torn country.

Trump immediately delivered all of Pakistan's demands by not only announcing a US$125 million preliminary military-aid package but also by declaring that he had spoken to Prime Minister Modi and offered US mediation to resolve the long-standing Kashmir dispute.

Even though the US and India are strategic partners, their interests in Afghanistan have often clashed. India wants the US to remain in Afghanistan as its presence over there prevents the Pakistani army from using Afghanistan both as a 'strategic depth' to fall back into in the event of a major Indian invasion following the continuous Pakistani use of terror as an extension of their anti-India foreign policy, and as a base for building their terror machinery against India, as they did during 1995–2001. The US wants to exit Afghanistan, as the American public is unwilling to both bear,